

Duty Refund Analysis

Historical-entry audit for Meridian Apparel Imports Inc.

Analysis date:
2026-05-13

AT A GLANCE

Entries analyzed
15
Line items analyzed
16
Refund opportunities surfaced
5

Total recoverable
\$1,818.91
Within PSC filing window
4 of 5
Require protest (outside window)
1

This is an AI-generated analysis. All findings require licensed customs broker review before any Post Summary Correction or protest is filed. customs-agent is not a licensed customs broker; we pair with a broker partner who exercises responsible supervision and control under 19 CFR Part 111.

Executive summary

We analyzed 15 entries (16 line items) filed under your import history. We identified 5 line items where we believe the classification filed was incorrect, representing \$1,818.91 in recoverable duties. 4 of 5 are within the PSC window; the remaining 1 are older and require a protest (CBP Form 19) within 180 days of liquidation. Of the recoverable total, \$1,504.70 is high-confidence and \$314.21 is medium-confidence (broker should verify against actual product details).

What happens next

- Review the refund opportunities (next section). Each finding includes the legal reasoning and the citations the agent relied on.
- Your licensed customs broker validates each finding against the actual product before filing. We pair with your existing broker or one of ours.
- Accepted findings are filed as Post Summary Corrections (within 314 days of liquidation) or as protests (within 180 days of liquidation).
- Refunds are typically issued by CBP within 90 days of an accepted PSC.

Refund opportunities

Finding 1 · \$547.35 recoverable

VN-VIE-8396462-01 · entry date 2026-02-15 · within PSC window · confidence high

Product as filed:

Men's cotton t-shirt black knit basic crew M

Filed classification 6105.10.00.10 duty paid: \$3,450.22	Our proposed classification 6109.10.00.12 duty under our code: \$2,902.87
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Why we believe this is misclassified:

Step 1 – Identify candidate headings. The article is described as "Men's cotton t-shirt black knit basic crew M".

This finding requires review by a licensed customs broker before filing a Post Summary Assessment Request under the classification's terms before action.

Finding 2 · \$504.41 recoverable

VN-VIE-8454992-15 · entry date 2025-09-01 · within PSC window · confidence high

Product as filed:

Cotton voile scarf lightweight printed 70x180cm

Filed classification 6214.30.00.00 duty paid: \$1,137.16	Our proposed classification 6214.90.00.10 duty under our code: \$632.75
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Why we believe this is misclassified:

STEP 1 — Identify candidate headings (4-digit). The product is described as "Cotton voile scarf lightweight printed 70x180cm." Two 4-digit headings prima facie cover this article: 6117 and 6214.

Heading 6117 — "Other made up clothing accessories, knitted or crocheted."

This finding requires review by a licensed customs broker before filing a Post Summary Assessment Request under the classification's terms before action.

Finding 3 · \$314.21 recoverable

VN-VIE-2919003-10 · entry date 2026-02-01 · within PSC window · confidence medium

Product as filed:

Men's cotton t-shirt black knit basic crew M

Filed classification 6105.10.00.10 duty paid: \$1,980.66	Our proposed classification 6109.10.00.12 duty under our code: \$1,666.45
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Why we believe this is misclassified:

Step 1 — Identify candidate headings. The product is a men's cotton t-shirt black knit basic crew M.

This finding requires review by a licensed customs broker before filing a Post Summary Assessment Request under the classification's terms before action.

Finding 4 · \$303.52 recoverable

VN-VIE-6144543-09 · entry date 2025-05-28 · outside PSC window — protest required · confidence high

Product as filed:

Cotton voile scarf lightweight printed 70x180cm

Filed classification 6214.30.00.00 duty paid: \$684.28	Our proposed classification 6214.90.00.10 duty under our code: \$380.76
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Why we believe this is misclassified:

Step 1: Identify candidate headings. The article is described as "Cotton voile scarf lightweight printed 70x180cm". Two 4-digit headings from the candidate set prima facie cover this article: Heading 6117 ("Other made up clothing accessories, knitted or crocheted") and Heading 6214 ("Other made up clothing accessories, knitted or crocheted").

This finding requires review by a licensed customs broker before filing a Post Summary Assessment Request under the classification's terms before action.

Finding 5 · \$149.42 recoverable

VN-VIE-9661144-02 · entry date 2026-03-29 · within PSC window · confidence high

Product as filed:

Men's short sleeve crew neck cotton t-shirt knitted white size L

Filed classification 6105.10.00.10 duty paid: \$958.44	Our proposed classification 6109.10.00.04 duty under our code: \$809.02
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Why we believe this is misclassified:

Step 1 – Identify candidate headings. The article is described as "Men's short sleeve crew neck cotton t-shirt knitted white size L." From the candidate set, the following 4-digit headings are identified: Heading 6109 – "T-shirts, singlets and other vests, knitted or crocheted".

This finding requires review by a licensed customs broker before filing a Post Summary Assessment Request under the classification's terms before action.

Methodology

Classification

Each line item is re-classified from the seller's product description against the full US Harmonized Tariff Schedule. The agent applies the General Rules of Interpretation (GRI 1 through 6) in legal order — first looking at the heading terms and binding chapter/section notes (GRI 1), then specificity and essential-character analysis (GRI 3) when more than one heading applies, then descending to the 6-, 8-, and 10-digit lines via GRI 6.

Citations

Every classification cites at least one source from the candidate set returned by retrieval — either an HTS heading, subheading, or chapter note. Citations are checked against the candidate set; classifications whose citations don't ground are rejected and re-attempted.

Confidence

"High" means we would defend this classification under a CBP focused assessment. "Medium" means the heading is likely correct but the 8-digit line depends on a value tier, material tier, or named-vs-residual choice that requires broker confirmation against actual product details. "Low" means two or more chapters remain plausible. Only high and medium opportunities appear in this report; low-confidence disagreements are listed separately for broker review.

Duty calculation

Duty under both the filed and proposed classifications is computed deterministically — no LLM involved in the math. We model base ad-valorem rates, Section 301 (China) add-ons, Section 232 (steel and aluminum), Merchandise Processing Fee (0.3464%, capped per CBP's annual schedule), and Harbor Maintenance Fee (0.125% for ocean freight). Rates come from a versioned snapshot of the official USITC tariff table.

PSC eligibility window

Post Summary Corrections may be filed within 314 days of entry liquidation, which is roughly within 11 months of the entry date. Entries older than the window are flagged in the appendix — those refunds, if accepted, must be pursued through the protest process (CBP Form 19) within 180 days of liquidation.

Limits

All findings in this report are AI-generated and require licensed customs broker review before any filing. customs-agent is not a licensed customs broker; we are an AI operations platform that pairs with a licensed broker partner who exercises responsible supervision and control under 19 CFR Part 111. We do not represent any importer before CBP; we provide analysis our broker partner uses to file. Recoverable amounts assume CBP accepts each re-classification — actual recovery depends on broker confirmation and CBP review.

Appendix — all entries analyzed

Below is every entry / line item we analyzed. "" indicates we agreed with the broker's filing; rows in the opportunities section above are flagged here as refund opportunities. Low-confidence disagreements are listed at the end.

Across 15 entries (16 line items): 11 agreed (we concur with filed classification), 5 refund opportunities surfaced, 0 flagged uncertain. Entry-level detail follows.

Disagreement detail

VN-VIE-8396462-01 · line 1 · 2026-02-15

Men's cotton t-shirt black knit basic crew M
filed 6105.10.00 -> our 6109.10.00 · recoverable \$547.35 · confidence high

VN-VIE-8454992-15 · line 1 · 2025-09-01

Cotton voile scarf lightweight printed 70x180cm
filed 6214.30.00 -> our 6214.90.00 · recoverable \$504.41 · confidence high

VN-VIE-2919003-10 · line 1 · 2026-02-01

Men's cotton t-shirt black knit basic crew M
filed 6105.10.00 -> our 6109.10.00 · recoverable \$314.21 · confidence medium

VN-VIE-6144543-09 · line 1 · 2025-05-28

Cotton voile scarf lightweight printed 70x180cm
filed 6214.30.00 -> our 6214.90.00 · recoverable \$303.52 · confidence high

VN-VIE-9661144-02 · line 1 · 2026-03-29

Men's short sleeve crew neck cotton t-shirt knitted white size L
filed 6105.10.00 -> our 6109.10.00 · recoverable \$149.42 · confidence high

